Google sign-in setup

Register a Google OAuth web client for your own Personal Archive installation. Each installation uses its own Google client credentials.

Before you start

You need access to Google Cloud Console, the site's final URL (or localhost during development), and the Google account that will administer the site. Personal Archive uses Google identity sign-in only; it does not need access to Gmail, Drive, Calendar, or other Google APIs.

1. Create or select a Google Cloud project

Open Google Cloud Console. Create a project for this installation or select one you control.

2. Configure Google Auth Platform

In that project, open Google Auth Platform and complete the Branding and Audience settings. Google may update the console labels over time.

- Set an app name and a support email you control.

- For a personal Google account, choose External audience. Internal is appropriate only when access should be limited to a Google Workspace organization.

- For a private single-owner site, leave Publishing status as Testing and add your own Google account under Test users.

- Keep the requested scopes to openid, email, and profile. Do not add unrelated Google API scopes.

3. Create a web client

Open Clients, choose Create client, and select Web application. Give the client a recognizable name. Under Authorized redirect URIs, add the callback for your installation:

```
Local development: http://localhost:3000/api/auth/callback/google
Public site:       https://your-domain.example/api/auth/callback/google
```

The callback must match exactly, including scheme, hostname, port, path, and trailing slash. For this server-side sign-in flow, Authorized JavaScript origins can remain empty.

Create the client and save its Client ID and Client secret. Keep the secret private.

4. Configure Personal Archive

Put the values in the private .env file for the same installation. Do not commit the file or share the client secret.

```
SITE_URL=https://your-domain.example
AUTH_URL=https://your-domain.example
AUTH_SECRET=<long-random-secret>
AUTH_GOOGLE_ID=<client-id>
AUTH_GOOGLE_SECRET=<client-secret>
ADMIN_EMAILS=you@example.com
```

- For local development, set SITE_URL and AUTH_URL to http://localhost:3000.

- Generate AUTH_SECRET separately from the Google client secret, for example with openssl rand -base64 32.

- Set ADMIN_EMAILS to the exact Google account email allowed to administer this site. Restart the app after changing environment values.

5. Test sign-in

Open /admin and choose Sign in with Google. In Testing mode, the account must be listed as a Google test user and included in ADMIN_EMAILS. Confirm that the admin area opens, then sign out and check that an account absent from ADMIN_EMAILS is refused.

Troubleshooting

- redirect_uri_mismatch: make sure the Google callback exactly matches the active SITE_URL and AUTH_URL.

- Access denied: check both Google's Test users list (while in Testing) and the ADMIN_EMAILS allowlist.

- Configuration error: check AUTH_SECRET, AUTH_GOOGLE_ID, AUTH_GOOGLE_SECRET, SITE_URL, and AUTH_URL, then restart the app.

Production and references

Use HTTPS and the final public domain in SITE_URL, AUTH_URL, and Google's authorized callback. A private single-owner site can remain in Testing. Before allowing unrelated Google users to authorize the app, review Google's current publishing and verification requirements.

Official Google references: Create a client ID; OAuth for web server applications; Production readiness. Console instructions checked October 14, 2026.